November 7, I received a check for $180. If we don't count "Grow Old Along with Me," then "The Evitable Conflict" was the eighteenth story in a row that I had written with only Campbell in mind and that Campbell had taken.

Meanwhile, on October 25, I received the galley proofs of Pebble in the Sky. It was the first time I had ever received galley proofs, and I handled them almost reverently and went over them with painstaking slowness. It took me a whole week to do the proofing.

Gertrude and I were picked up by Kupchan on November 4 and driven to New York (or to the Bronx at least, and we went the rest of the way to the Blugermans' by subway). I brought the precious proofs with me and made a date to see Bradbury on Sunday afternoon.

There was no reason for him to interrupt his weekend to see me on a Sunday afternoon, but he wanted to make sure I had done the proofreading well. Brad was another one of the list of people in my life who have been moved by my lack of sophistication and by my air of eager incompetence to take a lot of trouble over me and to protect me.

There's no need to mention Campbell and Dawson as two other examples.

On Sunday, the sixth, then, I visited my parents and showed them the galley proofs to their great satisfaction and then went on to Brad's place. He lived in Peter Cooper Village at that time, a development right next to Stuyvesant Town, with larger apartments at higher rents. I met his wife and his young daughter and then we sat down over the proofs.

He went over them, as Dawson used to go over my dissertation, checking what I had done and showing me how to do it better. Eventually he was satisfied and said I seemed to have done a careful job.

I was gratified and said, "Yes, it's amazing what you find when you see things in cold print. There was a place there, for instance, where I had my characters 'say icily,' and 'say frostily,' and 'say frigidly' about twenty times in two pages. I cut out all those adverbs."

"Good," said Brad. "It's always strongest if you just say 'he said' and use adverbs only as a last resort."

"Right," I said. "Goodness! The way it was, The New Yorker would have listed them all in their 'infatuated-with-the-sound-of-his-own-words' department."